VA SCANNER REPORT

Server Vulnerability Assessment - January 2026

Target Asset	Assessment ID
10.40.20.15	NXC-VA-SRV-2026-01-021
Asset Type	**Environment**
Server / Production Host	Production / Internal

Executive Summary

The January 2026 assessment identified **24 findings** on the production server. No Critical findings were observed, while **2 High** and **10 Medium** findings require prioritized remediation. Key risk themes include operating-system patching, legacy remote administration, database exposure, SMB security, service exposure, firewall scope, and audit visibility.

Overall Vulnerability Status: ACTION REQUIRED

24	0	2	10	8	4
TOTAL	CRITICAL	HIGH	MEDIUM	LOW	INFO

Scan Execution & Target Details

Scanner	Enterprise VA Scanner v6.4	**Scan Type**	Authenticated infrastructure vulnerability assessment
Target	10.40.20.15	**Protocol**	TCP/IP services and host configuration
Start	27 Jan 2026 09:02:18	**End**	27 Jan 2026 11:41:06
Duration	02h 38m 48s	**Scope**	Production / Internal
Assessment Month	January 2026	**Status**	ACTION REQUIRED

Assessment scope covered exposed network services, operating-system and package security, remote administration, transport security, database reachability, host firewall posture, local privilege controls, security auditing, and selected server-hardening indicators. Findings are synthetic examples created for documentation and workflow demonstration; they are not evidence of an actual scan of this IP address.

Detailed Findings & Recommendations

Each record retains the exact assessed target for traceability.

HIGH FINDINGS (2)

SRV-025 - Operating System Patch Level Below Baseline	HIGH
Target	10.40.20.15
Observation	The server was identified with multiple operating-system security updates missing from the approved production baseline.
Potential Impact	Known vulnerabilities in outdated components may permit remote exploitation or increase post-compromise impact.
Recommendation	Apply current vendor security updates through the approved patch-management process. Verify installed versions and perform a focused vulnerability retest.

SRV-026 - Remote Administration Service Allows Legacy Configuration	HIGH
Target	10.40.20.15
Observation	A remote administration service accepted a legacy configuration that does not align with the current secure-server baseline.
Potential Impact	Legacy administrative settings may increase credential exposure and provide additional attack paths for internal attackers.
Recommendation	Disable legacy options, enforce modern authentication and encryption, restrict management sources, and verify configuration after deployment.

MEDIUM FINDINGS (10)

SRV-027 - TLS Service Supports Deprecated Protocol	MEDIUM
Target	10.40.20.15
Observation	A TLS-enabled service accepted an older protocol version that is outside the preferred enterprise cryptographic baseline.
Potential Impact	Deprecated protocols may weaken transport security and expose clients to downgrade or compatibility risks.
Recommendation	Disable deprecated protocol versions and enforce approved TLS versions and cipher suites.

SRV-028 - Open Database Service Reachable from Broad Network Segment	MEDIUM
Target	10.40.20.15
Observation	A database-related port was reachable from a broader internal source range than required for the server role.

Potential Impact	Unauthorized systems may attempt authentication, exploit service weaknesses, or perform database reconnaissance.
Recommendation	Restrict database access to approved application and administration networks using host and network firewall rules.

SRV-029 - SSH Password Authentication Enabled	**MEDIUM**
Target	10.40.20.15
Observation	The SSH service permitted password-based authentication despite availability of stronger centralized or key-based controls.
Potential Impact	Password authentication increases exposure to credential guessing and stolen-password attacks.
Recommendation	Use key-based or centrally managed strong authentication and disable password authentication where operationally feasible.

SRV-030 - SMB Signing Not Enforced	**MEDIUM**
Target	10.40.20.15
Observation	SMB traffic did not consistently require message signing under the assessed configuration.
Potential Impact	Lack of signing may increase exposure to certain relay or traffic-manipulation scenarios within an internal network.
Recommendation	Require SMB signing according to the server baseline and validate compatibility with dependent systems.

SRV-031 - Excessive Listening Services	**MEDIUM**
Target	10.40.20.15
Observation	Multiple network services were listening beyond the minimum services expected for the server's documented role.
Potential Impact	Every unnecessary service increases attack surface and may expose additional vulnerabilities.
Recommendation	Review all listening services, disable unused components, and restrict required services to approved source ranges.

SRV-032 - SNMP Uses Insecure Configuration	**MEDIUM**
Target	10.40.20.15
Observation	SNMP was available with configuration that did not demonstrate the preferred secure management controls.
Potential Impact	Weak SNMP settings may disclose system information or permit unauthorized management activity.
Recommendation	Use SNMPv3 where possible, restrict management sources, and remove default or weak community configurations.

SRV-033 - Host Firewall Allows Broad Administrative Access	**MEDIUM**
Target	10.40.20.15
Observation	Administrative service ports were reachable from a wider internal segment than required.

Potential Impact	A compromised workstation or lower-trust internal host may directly target management services.
Recommendation	Limit management access to approved administration networks, jump hosts, or management VLANs.

SRV-034 - Insufficient Security Event Auditing	**MEDIUM**
Target	10.40.20.15
Observation	Selected authentication and privilege-related security events were not consistently captured at the required level of detail.
Potential Impact	Insufficient logs can delay detection and reduce forensic visibility after an incident.
Recommendation	Enable the approved audit policy, forward security events centrally, and verify retention and alerting.

SRV-035 - Weak Local Privilege Assignment	**MEDIUM**
Target	10.40.20.15
Observation	Local privileged group membership included access that should be reviewed against the server's operational role.
Potential Impact	Excessive privileges increase the impact of compromised accounts and facilitate privilege escalation.
Recommendation	Apply least privilege, remove unnecessary administrator membership, and perform periodic privileged-access reviews.

SRV-036 - Service Banner Reveals Software Version	**MEDIUM**
Target	10.40.20.15
Observation	A network service disclosed detailed implementation and version information during connection or error handling.
Potential Impact	Version information can assist targeted reconnaissance and exploitation planning.
Recommendation	Minimize unnecessary service-banner disclosure and maintain all exposed components on supported versions.

LOW FINDINGS (8)

SRV-037 - Default Web Server Configuration Detected	**LOW**
Target	10.40.20.15
Observation	A web service returned vendor-default behavior for selected invalid requests.
Potential Impact	Default configuration can disclose product characteristics and may indicate incomplete production hardening.
Recommendation	Replace default responses, remove unnecessary modules, and apply the approved web-server hardening baseline.

SRV-038 - Directory Indexing Enabled	**LOW**
Target	10.40.20.15

Observation	A service path allowed directory contents to be enumerated without an identified business requirement.
Potential Impact	Directory listings may expose filenames, temporary artifacts, or deployment information.
Recommendation	Disable directory indexing and explicitly control access to required static resources.

SRV-039 - Missing Cache-Control on Sensitive Responses	**LOW**
Target	10.40.20.15
Observation	Authenticated service responses did not consistently specify restrictive cache directives.
Potential Impact	Sensitive content may be retained in browser or intermediary caches longer than intended.
Recommendation	Apply appropriate no-store or private cache controls to sensitive responses.

SRV-040 - NTP Source Not Centrally Managed	**LOW**
Target	10.40.20.15
Observation	Time synchronization was not consistently aligned with the approved enterprise time sources.
Potential Impact	Time drift can affect authentication, event correlation, monitoring, and incident investigation.
Recommendation	Configure approved NTP sources and monitor synchronization health.

SRV-041 - Weak Certificate Management Configuration	**LOW**
Target	10.40.20.15
Observation	Certificate configuration did not fully align with the enterprise certificate-management baseline.
Potential Impact	Poor certificate hygiene can create trust failures and complicate secure service maintenance.
Recommendation	Use approved PKI certificates, maintain correct SAN values, and monitor renewal and expiration.

SRV-042 - Management Interface Exposed Beyond Required Segment	**LOW**
Target	10.40.20.15
Observation	A management-related interface was reachable from a broader internal segment than necessary.
Potential Impact	Broader reachability increases exposure of privileged services to compromised internal hosts.
Recommendation	Restrict management interfaces to dedicated administration networks or approved jump hosts.

SRV-043 - Host Hardening Baseline Incomplete	**LOW**
Target	10.40.20.15
Observation	Selected operating-system hardening parameters did not fully match the organization's secure-server baseline.
Potential Impact	Incomplete hardening may increase the impact of local exploitation or misconfiguration.

Recommendation	Apply the approved secure-server baseline and document any justified exceptions.

SRV-044 - Request or Connection Limits Not Explicitly Defined	**LOW**
Target	10.40.20.15
Observation	Selected network-facing services did not demonstrate clear connection or request limits appropriate to their role.
Potential Impact	Resource exhaustion may be easier if services accept excessive concurrent connections.
Recommendation	Configure service-specific connection and resource limits and monitor abnormal utilization.

INFO FINDINGS (4)

SRV-045 - Endpoint Security Agent Coverage Not Externally Verifiable	**INFO**
Target	10.40.20.15
Observation	The network assessment could not independently verify endpoint protection agent health.
Potential Impact	Network scanning cannot establish whether host security tooling is active and healthy.
Recommendation	Verify endpoint-agent deployment and health through centralized security-management evidence.

SRV-046 - Backup Success Not Externally Verifiable	**INFO**
Target	10.40.20.15
Observation	Backup configuration and successful recovery execution could not be established from network evidence.
Potential Impact	A scanned host may appear secure while recovery controls remain untested.
Recommendation	Validate backup schedules, retention, encryption, and restoration tests through operational evidence.

SRV-047 - Server Ownership Not Visible from Network Surface	**INFO**
Target	10.40.20.15
Observation	The assessment could not identify authoritative asset-owner information from the host interface.
Potential Impact	Unclear ownership can slow remediation and accountability.
Recommendation	Maintain authoritative CMDB or asset-inventory ownership records for the server.

SRV-048 - Patch Compliance Process Not Externally Verifiable	**INFO**
Target	10.40.20.15

Observation	The scan could identify missing updates but could not validate the complete organizational patch-compliance process.
Potential Impact	Network evidence alone cannot confirm exceptions, deadlines, or remediation governance.
Recommendation	Use centralized patch-management reporting to track compliance, exceptions, and remediation deadlines.

Remediation Summary

Priority	Severity	Count	Recommended Target	Closure Evidence
P1	HIGH	2	Immediate / next maintenance	Patch lifecycle; legacy administration controls; focused retest
P2	MEDIUM	10	Short-term patch cycle	Database, SSH, SMB, services, firewall and audit verification
P3	LOW	8	Planned hardening	Host baseline and service-configuration evidence
P4	INFO	4	Backlog / governance	Endpoint, backup, ownership and compliance evidence

Recommended Remediation Sequence

1. Patch critical infrastructure gaps: bring the operating system and exposed components to the approved supported baseline.

2. Protect administrative access: remove legacy remote-administration settings, strengthen SSH, and restrict management reachability.

3. Reduce network attack surface: close unnecessary services and restrict database and management ports to approved source networks.

4. Harden host security: enforce SMB signing, secure TLS, NTP, certificates, and operating-system hardening.

5. Improve detection and governance: strengthen security auditing and maintain centralized evidence for endpoint protection, backups, ownership, and patch compliance.

Scan Methodology & Limitations

The simulated assessment represents a typical enterprise infrastructure vulnerability-assessment workflow. Coverage includes network-service discovery, operating-system and package checks, remote administration configuration, database exposure, TLS posture, service exposure, firewall controls, local privilege configuration, audit logging, and selected hardening checks.

Limitations: automated network scanning may produce false positives or miss vulnerabilities requiring local authenticated inspection or application context. Patch compliance, backup success, endpoint-agent health, and organizational ownership must be validated through operational evidence.

Appendix - Scan Record

Field	Value
Report ID	NXC-VA-SRV-2026-01-021
Scanner	Enterprise VA Scanner v6.4
Target	10.40.20.15
Target Type	Server / Production Host
Environment	Production / Internal
Scan Start	27 Jan 2026 09:02:18
Scan End	27 Jan 2026 11:41:06
Scan Duration	02h 38m 48s
Total Findings	24
Severity	0 Critical / 2 High / 10 Medium / 8 Low / 4 Info
Overall Status	ACTION REQUIRED
Report Classification	CONFIDENTIAL - INFRASTRUCTURE SECURITY

End of Report